HEAL,STRENGTHEN,SHINE: GUIDELINES AND PRECAUTIONS FOR NEW MOTHERS

GUIDELINES

- **Attend postnatal check-ups:** Schedule regular check-ups with your healthcare provider to monitor your physical and emotional recovery
- **Start gentle exercises early:** Begin with gentle exercises like deep breathing, pelvic tilts, and Kegel exercises as soon as you feel comfortable after childbirth
- **Strengthen your core:** Engage in exercises that strengthen your core muscles, such as planks, bridges, and pelvic tilts
- **Practice good posture:** Maintain good posture to reduce strain on your back and pelvis
- **Use proper lifting techniques:** Lift your baby correctly to avoid straining your back and pelvis
- **Stay hydrated:** Drink plenty of water to help your body heal and recover
- **Get enough rest:** Prioritize rest and sleep to help your body recover from childbirth
- **Seek support:** Reach out to family, friends, or support groups for emotional support and help with childcare.



PRECAUTIONS

- **Don't overexert yourself:** Avoid heavy lifting, bending, or strenuous activities that can put strain on your body
- **Don't neglect your pelvic floor:** Failing to strengthen your pelvic floor muscles can lead to incontinence, prolapse, and other issues
- **Don't ignore pain or discomfort:** If you experience persistent pain or discomfort, seek medical attention to rule out any underlying issues
- **Don't rush back to exercise:** Wait for your healthcare provider's clearance before starting any new exercise program
- **Don't compare yourself to others:** Every woman's recovery is unique, so focus on your own progress and don't compare yourself to others
- **Don't neglect your mental health:** Postpartum depression and anxiety are common, so prioritize your mental health and seek help if needed
- **Don't forget to breathe:** Deep breathing can help reduce stress and promote relaxation
- **Don't hesitate to seek help:** If you experience any concerns or issues during your recovery, don't hesitate to seek help from your healthcare provider or a postnatal physiotherapist.

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REBUILD, RESTORE, REVITALIZE:

POSTNATAL EXERCISES FOR HEALTHIER YOU



Breathing and Relaxation Exercises

Deep breathing exercises: Lie on your back with your knees bent and feet flat on the floor. Take deep breaths in through your nose and out through your mouth, focusing on relaxing your body.



Progressive muscle relaxation: Lie on your back with your knees bent and feet flat on the floor. Tense and then relax different muscle groups in your body, starting with your toes and moving up to your head.

Pelvic Floor Exercises



Kegel contractions: Squeeze your pelvic floor muscles as if you're trying to stop the flow of urine. Hold for 5-10 seconds, release for 10-15 seconds. Repeat for 10-15 repetitions.



Pelvic floor lifts: Lie on your back with your knees bent and feet flat on the floor. Lift your pelvic floor muscles upwards and then release. Repeat for 10-15 repetitions.

Core Strengthening Exercises



Plank: Start in a push-up position with your hands shoulder-width apart. Engage your core muscles by drawing your belly button towards your spine. Hold for 30-60 seconds.

Posture and Mobility Exercises



Chest stretches: Stand in a doorway with your hands on the doorframe at shoulder height. Lean forward until you feel a stretch in your chest. Hold for 30 seconds.



Progressive muscle relaxation: Lie on your back with your knees bent and feet flat on the floor. Tense and then relax different muscle groups in your body, starting with your toes and moving up to your head.



Neck stretches: Slowly tilt your head to the side, bringing your ear towards your shoulder. Hold for 30 seconds and then repeat on the other side.